

OSINT ASSESSMENT · ANALYTICAL BRIEF

TLP: CLEAR

Southern Cone Human Trafficking – TBA Corridor

Open-source geospatial and documentary assessment of trafficking infrastructure · Argentina · Brazil · Paraguay

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DATE
May 2026

CLASSIFICATION
Unclassified

SITES ASSESSED
Alpha · Bravo · Charlie

TYPE
Analytical Brief



Fig. 1 · TBA Corridor · Site Overview

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report maps and corroborates human trafficking infrastructure across the Tri-Border Area (TBA) corridor using open-source satellite imagery, prosecutorial data, and documentary evidence. Three crossing sites were assessed — each representing a distinct modality — supported by multi-temporal Sentinel-2 spectral analysis, Google Earth Pro imagery, and cross-referencing against Brazil's forced-labour enforcement database (Lista Suja). The assessment identifies structural indicators of clandestine access at two sites, documents a systematic forced-labour absorption pattern in the Pantanal border zone, and establishes that the three sites function as an integrated system offering trafficking networks operational flexibility across formal, informal, and clandestine crossing types.

METHODOLOGY

Google Earth Pro

Sentinel-2 L2A

NDVI

Color Infrared (CIR)

NDWI

Multi-temporal analysis

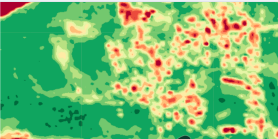
Lista Suja cross-reference

State Dept TIP Reports

UNODC · InSight Crime · OCCRP

Geospatial layer: Sentinel-2 L2A multi-temporal imagery (NDVI · CIR · NDWI) identifies surface disturbance, informal access infrastructure, and seasonal riverbank variation across acquisition windows 2019–2026. Documentary layer: UN Special Rapporteur reports on trafficking in persons · U.S. State Dept TIP Reports (2021–2025) · UNODC Global Report on Trafficking in Persons · InSight Crime and OCCRP network investigations · Lista Suja prosecutorial cross-reference.

SPECTRAL EVIDENCE



NDVI · Site Alpha · May 2026
Low-NDVI zone at shoreline consistent with informal dock infrastructure



CIR · Site Charlie · Apr 2026
Linear corridor inland from riverbank – vehicle access track beyond inspection range

LISTA SUJA – CORRIDOR CROSS-REFERENCE

13 Entries in corridor municipalities · 2022–2025	109 Workers in conditions analogous to forced labour	5 Entries in Corumbá alone — livestock / ranching	MS · PR Dominant states — Mato Grosso do Sul · Paraná
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SITE ASSESSMENT

ALPHA Foz do Iguaçu Lake Itaipú · BR/PY	Persistent informal dock confirmed across 3 Google Earth acquisitions (2019–2022) and Sentinel-2 NDVI/NDWI. Inconsistent with natural formation. Water crossingNDVI · NDWIMulti-temporal GE	CONFIDENCE MOD
BRAVO Ponta Porã P.J. Caballero · BR/PY	No physical barrier — continuous street grid across boundary. Zero Lista Suja entries: absence is the finding. Most permissive crossings produce fewest records. Open dry borderNo spectral anomalyStructural gap	CONFIDENCE HIGH
CHARLIE Posadas / Encarnación Paraná River · AR/PY	Informal access 7 km beyond inspection perimeter. NDVI and CIR (Jan 2025 · Apr 2026) show persistent vegetation gap. Austral summer low-water expands accessible riverbank. River crossingNDVI · CIRSeasonal variation	CONFIDENCE MOD

KEY FINDINGS

01 Three-site integrated system. Alpha (formal concealment), Bravo (frictionless movement), Charlie (clandestine river access) function together — networks shift between them as enforcement pressure changes.

02 Corumbá cluster is systematic. Five Lista Suja livestock entries in one Pantanal municipality (2024–2025). Remote fazendas are documented forced-labour absorption points — not random detections.

03 Absence as evidence. Zero Lista Suja entries at Ponta Porã reflects inspection gaps, not absence of exploitation — the structural gap documented by law enforcement operations.

04 Multi-stream convergence. Same corridor routes serve drug, arms, cigarette, and human trafficking simultaneously. One 2023 network (OCCRP) used both labour trafficking and goods smuggling through the same crossing infrastructure.

CONCLUSION

The multi-source OSINT assessment demonstrates that trafficking infrastructure in the TBA operates across a spectrum of formality — from clandestine riverbank access to high-volume formal bridge crossings — with each modality presenting vulnerabilities that conventional enforcement is structurally ill-equipped to address alone. The convergence of satellite indicators, Lista Suja prosecutorial data, and documented criminal network activity produces a coherent picture of a region where exploitation is sustained by geography, institutional capacity gaps, and the concealment afforded by the volume of legitimate commerce.

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ANALYTICAL BRIEF · FULL REPORT AVAILABLE ON REQUEST

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